QUEENS PEACE PALACE

TRAUMA & SAFETY RECLAMATION

A Guided Reflection for Understanding Trauma Responses,
Rebuilding Safety & Returning to the Present

NOTICE. SOOTHE. RECLAIM.

TO THY OWN SELF BE TRUE

The Inner Work Collection

Before You Begin

After trauma, reminders of what happened can affect the body, attention, sleep, mood, relationships, and sense of safety. Some people experience intrusive memories or nightmares; others avoid reminders, feel emotionally numb or detached, stay hyper-alert, startle easily, struggle with concentration, or carry guilt, shame, mistrust, or hopelessness.

This workbook is designed to help you notice your patterns without forcing you to relive the event in detail. You do not have to tell the entire story of what happened in order to begin understanding what your system is still responding to.

A gentle distinction	PTSD is a clinical diagnosis. This workbook does not diagnose PTSD or replace professional care. You can still use these pages to reflect on trauma responses, safety, triggers, and recovery whether or not you have a diagnosis.

YOUR INTENTION

What would you like to feel safer, clearer, or more supported around?

The danger can end before the alarm does.

Trauma can leave the mind and body responding as though danger is still close. The goal is not to judge the response. It is to recognize when the past is echoing into the present.

What situations, sensations, places, sounds, words, smells, dates, or dynamics tend to activate me?

How do I know I have been activated - emotionally, mentally, or physically?

What does my body seem to be preparing me for in those moments?

Your response was trying to protect you.

Trauma responses can look different from person to person. You may fight, flee, freeze, shut down, avoid, become hyper-alert, disconnect, over-control, or feel numb. The response is information - not a character flaw.

When I feel unsafe, overwhelmed, or reminded of the past, I tend to...

Which response feels most familiar: confrontation, escape, freezing, shutting down, pleasing, scanning, or something else?

What has this response protected me from? What does it cost me now?

Palace Reflection A survival response can be understandable and still become something you are ready to update.

Ask: What is true right now?

Triggers can collapse time. Part of reclaiming safety is gently noticing the difference between what happened then and what is happening now.

When I am activated, what facts can remind me that I am in the present?

What is different now - my age, choices, location, resources, boundaries, support, knowledge, or ability to leave?

What can I see, hear, touch, or notice around me that helps orient me to now?

Safety can be practiced in small, concrete ways.

Recovery does not have to begin with feeling completely safe. Sometimes it begins with identifying what makes a moment five percent safer, calmer, more predictable, or more within your control.

Where do I feel most at ease?

Who helps my body and mind soften rather than brace?

What routines, objects, environments, sounds, movement, or sensory experiences help me settle?

What makes a space or relationship feel unsafe to me now?

The body may carry what words cannot organize yet.

Stress can show up through muscle tension, sleep disruption, jumpiness, racing heart, restlessness, fatigue, or other physical sensations. Gentle body-based support may help some people feel more regulated.

Where does stress tend to live in my body?

What kind of movement or stillness feels supportive rather than overwhelming?

What helps my body recognize that it is allowed to soften?

Explore gently

Options may include breathing, walking, stretching, yoga, meditation, massage, acupuncture, or other supportive practices. Choose what feels safe and accessible; complementary practices are not substitutes for appropriate medical or mental-health care.

Avoidance can protect you - and sometimes shrink your world.

Avoiding reminders may provide immediate relief. Over time, it can also make certain places, conversations, feelings, or experiences seem increasingly dangerous. You do not need to force exposure. Start by noticing where avoidance is serving you and where it is limiting you.

What do I avoid because it reminds me of what happened?

Which avoidance feels protective and necessary right now?

Which avoidance may be keeping me from something I actually want?

What would a very small, supported step toward more freedom look like?

You do not have to monitor everything to deserve safety.

After trauma, attention can become trained toward threat. You may scan rooms, people, messages, sounds, exits, moods, or possibilities. The skill is not to shame the vigilance but to give your attention permission to notice neutral and safe information too.

What am I constantly scanning for?

What does my mind predict will happen if I stop monitoring?

What neutral or safe cues do I often miss when I am focused on danger?

Where can I practice letting my guard lower by one small degree?

Trauma can change the story you tell about yourself.

Guilt, shame, mistrust, betrayal, anger, grief, loneliness, numbness, and hopelessness can all appear after traumatic experiences. Feelings are real; they are not always accurate verdicts about who you are.

What emotion has been hardest for me to make room for?

What do I blame myself for?

What would I say to someone I loved who survived the same thing?

What belief about myself am I ready to question?

Remember You can learn from what happened without turning the event into evidence against your worth.

Rest is not the same as dropping your defenses.

Nightmares, trouble falling asleep, waking frequently, or feeling unsafe while resting can be part of trauma's aftermath. Rather than demanding perfect sleep, focus on what helps your environment and nervous system experience rest as more predictable.

What tends to make nighttime or rest feel harder?

What makes my sleep space feel more secure, familiar, or comforting?

What can I reduce before bed that tends to increase activation?

What simple signal could tell my body: the day is over, I am allowed to rest?

You do not have to heal alone.

Trauma can make trust difficult, but support does not have to mean surrendering control. You can decide what you share, with whom, at what pace, and what kind of help feels useful.

Who has earned enough trust for me to be honest with?

What kind of support actually helps me - listening, practical help, professional care, companionship, space, reassurance, advocacy?

What kind of response makes me shut down or feel misunderstood?

What would make asking for help feel more within my control?

What happened is part of your story - not the author of your future.

You are not required to find a silver lining, turn pain into purpose, help others, or be grateful for what happened. Meaning can be as simple as knowing yourself more clearly, protecting your peace differently, or refusing to let the event define what is possible next.

What have I learned about what I need, value, or refuse now?

What strength or truth about myself have I discovered?

Is there any meaning I genuinely want to carry forward - without forcing one?

Healing is not forgetting. It is having more life available to you.

Recovery can look like more choice, more presence, fewer decisions organized around fear, greater self-trust, stronger boundaries, deeper rest, safer connection, or simply more room to be yourself.

What has trauma been taking up too much room around?

What do I want more room for now?

What is one small choice that belongs to my present - not my past?

What would 'more life available to me' look like in ordinary terms?

THE PALACE CHECK-IN	Do not measure healing only by whether you ever get triggered again. Ask: Do I recognize what is happening sooner? Can I return to the present more gently? Do I have more choices? Do I trust myself more? Is my world slowly becoming larger?

RETURN TO YOURSELF

You are here now.
Your life is allowed to become larger.

Healing does not require you to erase what happened or become untouched by it. It can mean building enough safety, support, self-trust, and present-day choice that the past no longer has to make every decision for you.

Remember:	You do not have to force yourself to relive every detail in order to honor what happened and care for what remains.

Need support going deeper?

If this reflection uncovered something you would like support navigating, Queens Peace Palace offers private Spiritual Life Coaching for clarity, self-trust, relationships, transitions and personal growth.

queenspeacepalace.com

TO THY OWN SELF BE TRUE

Queens Peace Palace | The Inner Work Collection